City of Saint Paul

Meeting Minutes

City Council

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President Nelsie Yang
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

Wednesday, March 18, 2026 **3:30 PM** **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

Councilmember Kim may be participating remotely.

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:31 PM

Present 5 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Saura Jost and Councilmember Molly Coleman

Absent 2 - Councilmember Anika Bowie and Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson

CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Kim moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted

Yea: 5 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 2 - Councilmember Bowie and Councilmember Johnson

1 RES 26-176 Approving the City's cost of providing Securing and/or Emergency Boarding of a Structure on Private Property during the month of June 2025, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for April 14, 2026 and City Council public hearing for May 20, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2602B, Assessment No. 268108)

Adopted

2 RES 26-298 Approving the City's cost of providing Demolition of Vacant, Nuisance and/or

Hazardous Structure from the month of January 2026, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for April 14, 2026 and City Council public hearing for May 20, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2604C, Assessment No. 262003)

Adopted

3 RES 26-306 Authorizing the City to enter into a cooperative agreement with Ramsey County for their project on Jackson Street from Rose Avenue to Wheelock Parkway.

Adopted

4 RES 26-321 Approving the City's cost of providing Securing and/or Emergency Boarding services during July 2025 for 845 7th Street East, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for April 14, 2026 and City Council public hearing for May 20, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2603B3, Assessment No. 268112)

Adopted

5 RES 26-322 Approving the City's cost of providing Securing and/or Emergency Boarding services during June 2025 for 712 Snelling Avenue North, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for April 14, 2026 and City Council public hearing for May 20, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2602B1, Assessment No. 268108)

Adopted

6 RES 26-323 Approving the City's cost of providing Securing and/or Emergency Boarding services during September 2025 for 1566 GROTTO STREET NORTH, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for April 14, 2026 and City Council public hearing for May 20, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2605B1, Assessment No. 268113)

Adopted

7 RES 26-402 Authorizing the Department of Parks and Recreation to accept a sponsorship valued at $1,000 from Metro Transit to support Right Track's Career Exploration Day.

Adopted

8 RES 26-417 Accepting the gift of airfare, lodging, meals, and other travel expenses from the Dallas Fire Department for Assistant Chief Jeramiah Melquist to participate as an assessor for the Dallas Fire Captain test.

Adopted

9 RES 26-421 Changing the rate of pay for the classification of Assessment Supervisor (formerly Real Estate and Assessment Supervisor), EG 09.

Laid over to March 25, 2026

10 RES 26-423 Appointing Gordon Rees Scully Mansukhani as Special Counsel for Purposes

of Providing Legal Advice, Counsel, and Representation for Council Member Cheniqua Johnson in the lawsuit captioned: Jon Berry v. the City of Saint Paul, et. al.

Adopted

11 RES 26-425 Approving the Engagement Letter between the City and Brian T. Grogan and his firm Cozen O'Connor as special counsel representing the City for its ongoing Comcast cable-franchise negotiations.

Adopted

12 RES 26-429 Approving Ordinance Permit 20240030601 for Sanitary Sewer Infrastructure installed by Snelling-Midway Redevelopment, LLC at the following locations on the United Village Project Site as defined in the "Development Agreement By and Between Housing and Redevelopment Authority and Snelling-Midway Redevelopment, LLC": on Spruce Tree Avenue from Simpson Street to Pascal Street.

Adopted

13 RES 26-430 Extending the appointment of Iverson Reuvers as Special Counsel for Purposes of Providing Legal Advice, Counsel, and Representation in Civil Lawsuits Involving the City.

Adopted

14 RES 26-436 Authorize and accept temporary and permanent easements from property owners for the renovation of Osborn Plaza.

Adopted

15 RES 26-364 Establishing the rate of pay for Water Control Systems Information Analyst, Grade 046, Employee Group 02.

Adopted

ROLL CALL

Present 7 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

FOR DISCUSSION

16 RES 26-461 Recognizing the 2026 Eid al-Fitr and all Saint Paul residents who are celebrating the holiday.

Councilmember Kim read from the resolution and moved approval.

Councilmembers Noecker and Johnson spoke in favor.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

ORDINANCES

An ordinance is a city law enacted by the City Council. It is read at three separate council meetings and becomes effective after passage by the Council and 30 days after publication in the Saint Paul Pioneer Press. Public hearings on ordinances are generally held at the second reading.

Final Adoption

17 Ord 26-16 Granting the application of Xcel Energy to rezone property at 325 Commercial St from H1 Residential to I1 Light Industrial and amending Chapter 60 of the Legislative Code pertaining to the Zoning Map.

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

18 Ord 26-18 Amending Section 193.04 of the Legislative Code (Title XIX) to temporarily extend the pre-eviction notice period in Section 193.04 from 30-days to 60-days.

Council President Noecker spoke to a Version 3 amendment she planned to offer.

Corina Serrano from the St. Paul Public Housing Agency gave a staff report on Version 3.

All councilmembers continued discussion of Version 3.

Noecker moved to lay over for one week, to give time for additional consideration.

Laid over to March 25, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

PUBLIC HEARINGS

Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

19 Ord 26-17 Administrative Ordinance establishing the minimum qualifications for the

vacancy for the position of Fire Chief pursuant to the provisions of Section 12.12.1 of the City Charter.

Christine Hauge from the Department of Human Resources gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Sarah Gartner, resident, spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Bowie moved to close the public hearing and lay over for one week.

Laid over to March 25, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

20 RES PH 26-66 Approving the application of Allianz Field for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for the Great Lawn Concert Series event on the Fridays of May 29, July 24, July 31, August 14, and September 18, 2026, at 400 Snelling Avenue North - Outside of Allianz Field.

Zacharia Litzelswope from the Minnesota United Football Club spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Bowie moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

21 RES PH 26-67 Authorizing the Police Department to accept the 2026 Intensive Comprehensive Peace Officer Education and Training 2026 (ICPOET) from the State of Minnesota, Department of Public Safety, Office of Justice Programs; authorizing the execution of the grant agreement and amending the 2026 grant budget and adding activity budget.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

22 PH 26-4 Public hearing on grievances about federal immigration operations.

Councilmember Yang moved to close the public hearing and gave remarks.

Public hearing closed

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Kim moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

23 RLH TA 25-357 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 724 CASE AVENUE. (File No. J2512E2, Assessment No. 258327) (Public hearing continued to October 7, 2026)

Public hearing continued to October 7, 2026

24 RLH SAO 26-20 Appeal of Hannah Larson to a Summary Abatement Order at 760 COTTAGE AVENUE EAST.

Adopted

25 RLH FCO 26-20 Appeal of Kali Terry to a Fire Inspection Report at 392 EDMUND AVENUE.

Adopted as amended

26 RLH SAO 26-15 Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 120 FLANDRAU PLACE in Council File RLH SAO 26-5.

Adopted

27 RLH VO 26-15 Appeal of Elizabeth Sibet, Sibet Renovations, LLC, to a Notice of Condemnation and Order to Vacate at 227 FULLER AVENUE. (March 17, 2026 Legislative Hearing)

Public hearing continued to March 25, 2026

28 RLH VBR 26-1 Appeal of Raim Abdurakhimov to a Vacant Building Registration Notice and a Notice of Condemnation and Order to Vacate at 935 GERANIUM AVENUE EAST.

Adopted

29 RLH RR 26-3 Ordering the rehabilitation or razing and removal of the structures at 118 MANITOBA AVENUE within fifteen (15) days after the March 18, 2026, City Council Public Hearing. (Refer to April 28, 2026 Legislative Hearing)

Referred to April 28, 2026 Legislative Hearing

30 RLH AR 26-7 Ratifying the assessment for Removal of Diseased and/or Dangerous Tree(s) at 837 PEDERSEN STREET. (File No. 2602T, Assessment No. 269001)

Adopted

31 RLH SAO 26-23 Amending Council File RLH SAO 26-11, adopted March 4, 2026, to grant Negil Neely an additional extension for property at 1079 WESTERN AVENUE NORTH.

Adopted

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 4:52 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

Council Meeting Information
The City Council is paperless which saves the environment and reduces expenses. The agendas and Council files are all available on the Web (see below). Council members use mobile devices to review the files during the meeting. Using a mobile device greatly reduces costs since most agendas, including the documents attached to files, are over 1000 pages when printed.

Web
Meetings are available on the Council's website. Email notification and web feeds (RSS) of newly released minutes, agendas, and meetings are available by subscription. Visit www.stpaul.gov/council for meeting videos and updated copies of the agendas, minutes, and supporting documents.

Cable
Meetings are live on St Paul Channel 18 and replayed at various times. Check your local listings.